

BOARD UPDATE • Q2 2026

Meridian Freight

The quarter beat plan, but a carrier-capacity squeeze needs a board decision today.

We beat plan on revenue and margin — and we need your call on capacity by Friday.

Bottom line up front: Q2 revenue landed 11% ahead of plan and contribution margin expanded for the third straight quarter. The one open question is carrier capacity for peak season, and it requires board approval this week.

- Strong quarter, clean balance sheet, no surprises in the numbers.
- One time-boxed decision: pre-buy capacity now, or risk Q4 service levels.

Revenue, margin, and cash all came in ahead of plan.

\$58.4M

Quarterly revenue

PLAN \$52.6M • +11% **AHEAD** BOARD



31%

Contribution margin

+3PP QOQ **AHEAD** AUDIT

\$41M

Cash & equivalents

+\$6M QOQ **ON PLAN** INVESTOR

DEMAND • Q2 2026

Growth was broad — every region and lane category pulled its weight.

Measured against Q2 2025, same lane mix, normalized for fuel surcharge.



Demand is outrunning the carrier capacity we have contracted.

Volume is up 18% year over year, but our committed carrier capacity grew only 9%.

Through Q2 we covered the gap on the spot market — fine in a soft rate environment, but peak season changes that math.

- Spot exposure was 14% of loads in Q2, up from 6% a year ago.
- Spot rates historically spike 30–40% from October through December.

THE EXPOSURE WE ARE CARRYING INTO PEAK

\$4.2M

of incremental Q4 cost if we cover peak
demand on the spot market at last
year's rate curve.

A capacity pre-buy locks rates now, before the peak-season run-up.

Carriers will commit Q4 capacity at today's rates in exchange for a guaranteed minimum. Signing in June secures the lanes we need at roughly 22% below the spot curve we'd otherwise pay in Q4.

- The commitment is \$9.8M of guaranteed spend across four core carriers.
- Break-even holds even if peak volume comes in 15% below forecast.

The pre-buy is the only option that protects both service and margin.

Protects service • Hurts margin.

Cover peak entirely on the spot market

Hurts service • Hurts margin.

Cap volume to contracted capacity, turn away demand

Hurts service • Protects margin.

Defer the decision to Q3 and renegotiate

Protects service • Protects margin.

Pre-buy Q4 capacity now at locked rates

The pre-buy pays for itself even in a soft-demand scenario.



Full-year guidance holds, with upside if peak demand lands as forecast.

\$238M

FY revenue guide

REAFFIRMED **ON PLAN** BOARD



30%

FY contribution margin

+2PP VS FY25 **ON PLAN** AUDIT

99%

peak coverage with pre-buy

VS 86% WITHOUT **DECISION** OPS

We ask the board to approve a \$9.8M Q4 capacity pre-buy this week.

APPROVE THE PRE-BUY

Locks peak rates 22% below spot and protects our 96% on-time record.

DEFER TO Q3

Cedes the rate window; exposes Q4 to a projected \$4.2M spot premium.

ELENA MARSH • CEO • BOARD@MERIDIANFREIGHT.EXAMPLE

Strong quarter —
let's protect the peak.